

which are basically groups of people starting a group chat that you can be a part of. You can also attach any files present on your device such as videos, pictures and documents. In the additional settings menu (3 vertical dots) you will see options to send a Ping (which is basically an alert that vibrates the other BBM user's phone), Copy Chat, Email Chat and End Chat. Apart from this, in the main conversation screen you will see an icon on the top right. This will either be grey or green in colour. This icon is either a voice (musical note) or a video icon, depending on whether the contact you're chatting with has an OS 6/7 or BlackBerry 10 phone. Those who have BBOS 6/7 phones can have voice conversations with you, and those with BlackBerry 10 phones can have either voice or video chats with you. When the person is available, connected to Wi-Fi or 3G, the icon will be green, while if they're not, the icon is grey.

In any BBM screen, you can swipe down from the top bezel of the screen to show the settings menu. You will see the standard Help icon, a Scan to Invite icon that lets you scan other BBM users' QR code to invite them and the Settings icon. The settings available for BBM include the ability to turn on or off: Show What I'm Listening To, Show My Country and Time, Allow BBM Calls over Mobile Networks (using 3G/4G), Contacts Layout (Grid or List), Show Display Pictures in Chats, Automatically Record Voice Notes, Add Contacts On Tap, Security Question on Invites, Music Status Updates, Save Chat History, Chat History Delete (button), and Blocked Contacts Edit (button). All of these ought to be pretty self explanatory.

We would have liked the option to be able to easily select whether or not you want to be available for BBM voice or video calls. As it stands, you can turn off the Allow BBM Calls over Mobile Networks feature to do this when on a mobile network, but you cannot do this when you're connected to Wi-Fi. Also, you might want to be able to group contacts and apply permissions based on that group, to be able to control who sees what, but you can't do that either. It's a rather simple solution in these rather complex social networking days, and BBM assumes that if you're connected to someone else on BBM, you want to share everything with them. For example, you might want to update your status and show it only to your close friends and family, and not work people who are also on your BBM. Currently, you cannot do this unless you also have an enterprise account for your work, and those are few and far between already. You may want to be available for video calls to a certain group, voice calls to another, and not available for anything but chat to a third group, and again you cannot do this. These are some of the